

Music, Science & Technology

I. Required Portfolio Elements

1. Music Technology Work: Maximum of Three Examples

Stanford accepts examples of experiences with music technology. These may include, but are not limited to:

- **Compositions:** electronic music, computer music, sound design, or other technology-based creative work;
- **Improvisations:** performances or experiments involving electronic devices, software, or interactive systems;
- **Software:** original music software, audio tools, interactive programs, or related systems;
- **DIY music instruments:** self-built electronic instruments, sound installations, or new musical interfaces;
- **Writing samples of music technology research:** research papers, experimental reports, or other relevant written work.

Students may upload any media file type accepted by the application platform. There is no set time limit for music technology submissions. If one project requires multiple files to represent it fully, multiple related files may be submitted, but the portfolio should still contain no more than three project examples.

2. Music Résumé

The Arts Portfolio form includes a music résumé. It should be concise and clearly organized, and may include current and previous instructors, musical interests, awards and honors, select performance or project experience, relevant coursework, technical tools, and representative works. The applicant's name should be included in the file name.

3. Arts Recommendation (Optional)

Students submitting a Music portfolio are encouraged to include an optional letter of recommendation from an arts instructor or another person in a mentoring role. The letter is not required. If included, the recommender must submit it by the portfolio materials deadline.

II. Submission Rules

- Applicants are limited to **one Arts Portfolio** and should focus on one category only. Students presenting music technology work should select Music, Science & Technology rather than combining multiple music categories.
- In the Common Application, select “Yes” in response to “Do you intend to submit an Arts Portfolio?” and submit the Common Application by the applicable early deadline.

- After Stanford receives the application, the applicant will normally receive instructions for accessing the Stanford Portal within 48 hours. The Optional Arts Portfolio form, portfolio materials, music résumé, and recommender information are all submitted through the Portal.
- Do not send portfolio materials directly to the Department of Music or individual faculty members. Only materials submitted through Stanford’s official Arts Portfolio process can be reviewed.
- Follow the file type, file size, and upload instructions displayed in the Stanford Portal for the relevant application cycle.

III. Timeline for the 2026–2027 Application Cycle

Decision Plan	Common Application	Portfolio Materials	Standard Deadline
Restrictive Early Action (REA)	October 15, 2026	October 20, 2026	November 1, 2026

Materials due by the standard deadline include official transcripts, two teacher evaluations, and the School Report and counselor recommendation. Arts Portfolio applicants must submit the Common Application by the earlier portfolio-related deadline rather than waiting until the standard application deadline.

IV. Suggestions for Organizing Music Technology Projects

The following suggestions are intended to help reviewers understand each project efficiently. **They are not a required Stanford format.**

1. **Original music or sound work:** submit the completed audio or video and briefly explain the creative concept, the applicant’s individual contribution, the software or technology used, and how the work developed through iteration.
2. **Music software, an interactive installation, or a DIY music instrument:** use a short demonstration video to show how the project works and include a concise project description. If relevant, provide an accessible website or code repository link.
3. **A research-based or interdisciplinary project:** clearly present the research question, methods, experimental or production process, findings, and reflection. Avoid submitting only the final product without showing the thinking and development behind it.

The three examples do not need to use the same format. A strong combination can demonstrate musical expression, technical ability, and an exploratory process. Each submission should clearly identify which parts were completed by the applicant.